

Code of Conduct

Document and Version History

Version	Release Date	Description of Change	Created/Modified by	Approved by
1.0	20-Apr-2021	Initial	HR Team	Arun Ganesan, Senior Director – Technology
1.1	29-Jul-2024	Sexual Harassment Complaint Committee	HR Team	Gayathri Vivekanandan, CEO

I. Policy Brief & Purpose

Our Employee Code of Conduct policy outlines our expectations regarding employees' behavior towards their colleagues, supervisors and overall organization. The Company strives to demonstrate the highest standards of ethical conduct. The company does not grant waivers to its conduct, conflict of interest and compliance standards. We promote freedom of expression and open communication. The purpose of the Code of conduct is to describe principles of business conduct and to provide guidance in ethical decision making. The Company expect all employees to follow the code of conduct. They should avoid offending, participating in serious disputes and disrupting our workplace. The company also expect them to foster a well-organized, respectful and collaborative environment.

II. Scope

The Code applies to all employees, contractors and the members of the Board of Directors, which for purposes of the Code are referred to as "Employees". Contractors include any consultants, suppliers and vendors who are required to have access to company's confidential, business and proprietary information in order to perform their duties.

III. Compliance

All employees must protect the company's legality. Employees should comply with all environmental, safety and fair dealing laws. The Company expect employees to be ethical and responsible when dealing with the company's finances, products, partnerships and public image. Employees are responsible for knowing and complying with the requirements applicable to work activities, including those described in this Code and those described in company guidance documents (policies, standards, procedures, bulletins, and manuals).

IV. Adherence to Code of Conduct

The Company strives to demonstrate the highest standards of ethical conduct. The company does not grant waivers to its conduct, conflict of interest and compliance standards.

V. Fair & Respectful Workplace

The Company has no tolerance on any kind of discriminatory behavior, harassment or victimization. Employees should conform with equal opportunity in all aspects of their work, from recruitment and performance evaluation to interpersonal relations.

The Company is committed to achieving a positive work environment characterized by professional, dignified, courteous and respectful conduct – an atmosphere marked by esteem for the worth of people, where every colleague and stakeholder is treated fairly and where professional views and opinions can be discussed openly and courteously.

The employees come from a variety of backgrounds, and the Organization places much value on this diversity. The employees also operate in a multicultural environment and need to be mindful to keep their loyalty to the Company and their adherence to ethical principles above their own personal origins, beliefs, opinions, preferences, or habits. They must consider how behaviors and/or actions may be perceived by others and be accountable for their own actions.

a) Disrespect

Disrespectful behavior in terms of lack of the minimum level of courtesy and dignity in interaction with others, or inappropriate conduct, comment or display that either insults, denigrates, disparages or humiliates someone or depreciates their value, amounts to a breach of ethical principles and may lead to disciplinary actions. Disrespect may also relate to general statements or attitudes regarding the diversity of human beings and their worth. It can also translate into disrespect for people's work and for the Organization, its mandate.

b) Discrimination & Favoritism

The Organization prohibits discrimination based on gender, race, religion or belief, nationality, ethnic or social origin, age, sexual orientation, marital status, disability or other aspects of personal status. Discrimination includes actions, made either directly or indirectly, based on distinctions or prejudices which have the purpose or effect of treating individuals or groups unfairly or unjustly. It may include a series of events or a one-time incident.

c) Abuse of Authority

The abuse of authority/power is the improper use of a position of influence, power or authority by an individual towards others. This is particularly serious when the alleged offender uses his or her influence, power or authority to negatively influence the career or employment conditions (including, but not limited to, appointment, assignment, contract renewal, performance

evaluation or promotion) of other individuals. Abuse of authority can include a one-time incident or a series of incidents. It may also consist of conduct that creates a hostile or offensive work environment, which includes, but is not limited to, the use of intimidation, threats, blackmail or coercion. Decisions made through the proper use of managerial and supervisory responsibilities are not considered as abuse of authority.

d) Workplace Harassment

Harassment is an unwanted behavior directed at another identified person.

Harassment may:

- Happen between an individual against another individual, either at the same hierarchical level or between individuals with different hierarchical levels and/or different contractual status.
- Take the form of bullying, characterized by the underlying perception of an imbalance of power, and by the repeated or habitual use of force, physical and/or emotional aggression or coercion to intimidate or dominate others.
- Occur between a group and an individual, in which case it is referred to as “mobbing”.

Harassment may be obvious, or it may be insidious, and interfere with the recipient’s ability to carry out their functions and/or create an intimidating or hostile work environment. Harassment can make someone feel anxious, angry, frustrated or humiliated. Harassment may be present in the form of words, gestures, or other actions that alarm, threaten, abuse, demean, intimidate, belittle, or cause personal humiliation, embarrassment or emotional distress to another person. Harassment may not necessarily happen face to face but may also occur in written communications, email, phone, and supervision methods.

e) Sexual Harassment

The Organization does not tolerate sexual harassment. Sexual harassment is a particularly severe form of harassment handled by the Policy on Prevention of Harassment. Sexual harassment is understood as any unwelcome, unsolicited and unreciprocated, sexual advance, request for sexual favor, verbal or physical conduct or gesture of a sexual nature, or any other behavior of a sexual nature (including pornography, sexually colored remarks) that has or that might reasonably be expected or be perceived to offend, humiliate or intimidate another person.

Individuals found to have engaged in acts of sexual harassment will be subject to disciplinary measures in accordance with The Organization Policy, including being terminated. In severe corroborated cases, they may also become the subject of criminal proceedings.

Complaint Mechanism

An appropriate complaint mechanism in the form of “Complaints Committee” has been created in the Company for time-bound redressal of the complaint made by the victim.

Complaints Committee

The Company has instituted a Complaints Committee for redressal of sexual harassment complaint (made by the victim) and for ensuring time bound treatment of such complaints. Initially, and till further notice, the Complaints Committee will comprise of the following four members:

- 1. Presiding Officer: Bhavani Kattavur Raman**
- 2. Gayathri Vivekanandan (Member)**
- 3. Arun Ganesan (Member)**
- 4. Sugumar (Member)**

The Presiding Officer reserves the right to nominate more members of appropriate seniority and rank in the committee to conduct such enquiries to ensure equal representation of the gender as that of the complainant or for any other valid reason. The Complaints Committee is responsible for:

- Investigating every formal written complaint of sexual harassment
- Taking appropriate remedial measures to respond to any substantiated allegations of sexual harassment.
- Discouraging and preventing employment-related sexual harassment

f) Workplace Free from Violence

The Organization will not tolerate workplace violence in any form either within premises or outside where company related activities are carried out. Employees are expected to not indulge in workplace violence. They must not encourage others towards it as well. Employees are also prohibited from possessing weapons or dangerous items at workplace or outside while conducting business activities.

g) Open Door Communication

The Organization believes that the work environment should be free from any kind of bureaucracy and all employees must have access to other employees regardless of their position or influence in the company. All managers are expected to foster an open-door culture at the workplace.

h) Prohibition of child labor

The Organization strictly prohibits the employment of child labor at its premises. All employees who are responsible for hiring are required to ensure that this principle is upheld.

i) Environmental, Health & Safety

The Organization is committed to provide its employees a safe, healthy, and ergonomically sound working environment. The company will take all possible measures to ensure health and safety of its employees. Safety at workplace is also every employee's responsibility. All employees and visitors to the workplace must comply with safety norms/policies/standards as prescribed by the company and applicable law. All employees must ensure that no unsafe act is committed at workplace. Employees must also undertake all possible measures to eliminate any unsafe condition as soon as they become aware of it. If an employee witnesses any unsafe act or unsafe condition, they should report to relevant authorities at the earliest.

j) Human Rights

The Organization recognizes the importance of maintaining and promoting fundamental human rights in all our operations and throughout our values, codes and employment policies work together to support the principles of Human Rights. We operate under the program and policies that: -

- Provide fair and equitable wages, benefits and other conditions of employment.
- Are in accordance with local laws
- Provide humane and safe working conditions
- Prohibit all forms of forced and compulsory labor or child labor
- Promote workplace free of discrimination and harassment

k) Equal Opportunity for All

The Organization gives equal opportunity to all and does not discriminate against any person because of their gender, caste, religion, age (within statutory limits), marital status, nationality, ancestry, ethnicity, geographical origin, sexual orientation, disability or any other trait protected by law, with respect to any terms of employment such as hiring, promotion, transfer, compensation & benefits, career development opportunities, etc. It is expected that managers shall take employment related decisions based only on the merit of the person and not discriminate against any person because of their personal characteristics/traits.

l) Code of Personal conduct

- All employees are expected to demonstrate the highest standards of honesty and integrity in their conduct at all time while representing the Company and conducting business on behalf of the Company.
- All employees are expected to demonstrate respect and trustworthy behavior in their dealings with other employees as well as external stakeholder.
- All employees are expected to uphold the spirit of teamwork and ensure that the best interest of the team and Company always prevails.
- All employees are expected to maintain a drug-free environment at workplace and refrain from substance abuse of any form while performing your duty within premises or outside of it. Employees are also prohibited from selling, distributing, possessing or encouraging others to use controlled substances.

m) Drugs and Alcohol

The abuse of drugs and alcohol can threaten the safety of the employees and have an adverse effect on job performance and Company's reputation. The Organization will not tolerate any employee being under the influence of drugs or alcohol while performing his job, including but not limited to driving on business. Employees who violate our drug and alcohol policy may be subject to potential criminal liability as well as appropriate disciplinary action, including termination of employment.

VI. Protection of Company Property

All employees should treat our company's property, whether material or intangible, with respect and care.

Employees:

- Should not misuse **company equipment** or use it frivolously.
- Should respect all kinds of **incorporeal property**. This includes trademarks, copyright and other property (information, reports etc.) Employees should use them only to complete their job duties.
- Employees should protect company facilities and other material property from damage and vandalism, whenever possible.

a) Company Confidential Information

For the Company, confidential information is a valuable asset, and every director, employee and agent of the Company must protect it. Confidential information includes all non-public information. It also includes personal information (regardless of its source) that all obtain during business. The employees must take care that all confidential information is used for Company business purposes only and in case of personal information, in addition, it must be processed on instructions from the Company in

accordance with laid out policies, procedures and guidelines and as per applicable privacy laws and regulations.

b) Accuracy of Record

It is crucial that the Organization maintains accurate records and internal control systems. As such, the employees must record all transactions and prepare accurate and complete records, in accordance with established procedures. The employees must not inaccurately record time for reporting purposes, provide false or intentionally misleading information to the Organization, submit false or misleading claims or falsify any official the Company documents. Such actions could result in disciplinary actions.

c) Intellectual Property & Publications

The intellectual property of the Company must be protected as a vital business asset. Our intellectual property portfolio includes copyrights, patents, trademarks, service marks, trade secrets, design rights, logos, brands and know-how. We must focus on protecting these assets. It is important to ensure that to the extent permitted by law, the rights to all intellectual properties created using the Company's time and expense that which are within the scope of our duties are assigned to and are the property of the Company. The Company/employee should promptly disclose any works, inventions or developments that are created to obtain legal protection over them.

d) Use of Company Assets

The use of the Company assets for individual profit or any unlawful, unauthorized personal or unethical purpose is prohibited. The Company's information technology, intellectual property (e.g., copyrights, patents, and trademarks), facilities, equipment, machines, software, and cash may be used for business purposes only, including responsible and accurate expense reimbursement, and in accordance with applicable policies.

Other assets (e.g., computers, printers, and copiers) may be used for minor and incidental personal purposes provided such use is kept to a minimum, and does not create any significant incremental costs, interfere with work duties, or violate any laws or Company policies. The use of any Company resources for personal political activities is prohibited.

Computer hardware, software, data, and facilities are valuable resources that need protection from potential destruction, theft, or misuse. These resources may also include confidential client or Company information that requires safeguarding. It is employee's responsibility to prevent unauthorized access using ID badges, passwords, or other security codes, and physical security measures (such as using computer cable locks, not leaving computers unattended in cars, and other normal precautions). Copyrighted materials (e.g., books, music, software, and magazines) should not be reproduced, distributed, or altered without permission of the copyright owner or an authorized agent. Software used in connection with the business of the Company should be properly licensed and used only in accordance with that license. Using unlicensed software could constitute copyright infringement and may be grounds for disciplinary action.

e) Social Media Usage

The Organization expects the employees to comply with applicable laws and government guidelines governing social media. When using any form of social media, one must comply with this Code of Conduct. The employees must not disclose any confidential information about the Company or any of its employees, contractors or third-party vendors. The Organization do not encourage sharing and being part of any political or social propaganda on behalf of the Company unless specifically asked to do so.

f) Data Security

The Organization maintains sensitive data and other information which is valuable to the functioning of its business. It is imperative that such information does not end up in the wrong hands. Thus, only employees who have a need to use confidential data or sensitive information will have access to it. Whenever the Organization receives a request to disclose potentially sensitive or confidential information such disclosure must be both appropriate and legally necessary.

VII. Anti-Bribery & Corruption

The Organization follows zero tolerance policy on bribery and corruption or other facilitation payments in any form whether in government or non-government dealings. The company prefers forgoing business opportunities rather than paying bribes. Employees accepting gifts from clients or partners is not appreciated. The Organization prohibit briberies for the benefit of any external or internal party.

VIII. Conflict of Interest

When the interests or benefits of one person conflict with the interests or benefits of the Company, a conflict of interest is said to occur. The Employees must avoid situations involving actual or potential conflict of interest so that even the slightest doubt about the company's integrity is not raised. Conflicts of interest also occur when the employee or their family members receive improper personal benefits, or preferential treatment as a result of our position, or the position of a family member, in the Company. Remember that such situations might impact our judgment or responsibilities towards the Company and the shareholders and customers.

This Code of Conduct is not exhaustive and lays down only the general principles to be followed by all pares as covered under the code. The company may have separate codes/policies formulated for regulating various matters that may be required under the specific laws. The parties shall be responsible for adhering to such additional codes/policies as may be applicable to them.